

August Membership Report

Monthly executive report summarizing GC membership performance, acquisition, retention, and recovery through the latest reporting period.

TOTAL ACTIVE MEMBERSHIP

525,382

2.9% vs prior month

NET MEMBERSHIP CHANGE

+14,918

July net active members

YEAR-TO-DATE GROWTH

+81,139

+18.3% vs December

TWELVE-MONTH CHANGE

+25.0%

vs July 2025

YEAR OVER YEAR GROWTH

Active Members by Year

Same month across years, back to 2022.

Year	Active Members	YoY Growth
Jul '22	74K	-
Jul '23	224K	204.1%
Jul '24	328K	46.2%
Jul '25	420K	28.1%
Jul '26	525K	25.0%

WHAT LEADERSHIP SHOULD KNOW

Key Takeaways

- Overall membership is strong**
Active membership remains well ahead of last year, but the lift is being driven by stronger retention, not higher acquisition.
- Acquisition is softer year over year**
Year-to-date new golfers are down versus 2025, making renewal performance more important to overall membership growth.
- Retention is sustaining momentum**
On-time renewal reached 83.4% in July, well above 66.0% last July. The cohort view also shows 69.2% active beyond 13 months across eligible cohorts.

MEMBERSHIP MOVEMENT

July Membership Reconciliation

What changed in July to reach the current membership total.

510,464
OPENING

 →

+21,844
ACQUIRED

 →

-11,860
LOST

 →

+4,934
RECOVERED

 →

525,382
CLOSING

YEAR-END OUTLOOK

2026 Year-End Projection

Actuals through July. Projection applies the current July YoY growth rate to remaining prior-year months.

555,330

25.0% GROWTH SCENARIO PROJECTED BY EOY

Year	Year-End Projection
2022	105K
2023	248K
2024	361K
2025	444K
2026 projected	555K

GC Acquisition

New Golfers measures newly created GHIN numbers by source.

NEW MEMBERS

21,844

-14.1% vs July 2025

July 2026

NEW GOLFERS YTD

131,031

-2.3% vs Jan-July 2025

Jan through July

YTD AS % OF ACTIVE

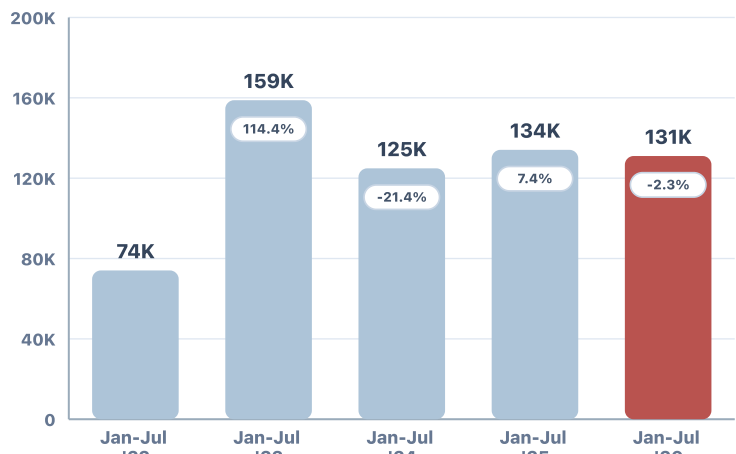
24.9%

-21.8% vs July 2025

Current active base

NEW GOLFERS CUMULATIVE YOY

New Golfers Cumulative YoY (Jan-July)



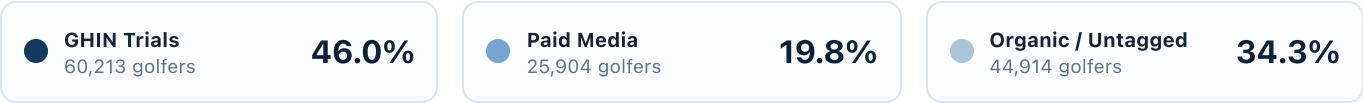
WHAT LEADERSHIP SHOULD KNOW

Key Takeaways

- Acquisition trend is concerning**
YTD new GHIN numbers are down -2.3% versus Jan-July 2025, and July was down -14.1% versus last year.
- Monthly source mix is shifting**
Organic / Untagged represented 29.9% of July new golfers, while YTD source mix remains concentrated in GHIN Trials and untagged activity.
- Retention is backstopping growth**
Despite softer acquisition, active membership remains up because renewal performance and retained members are carrying more of the growth load.

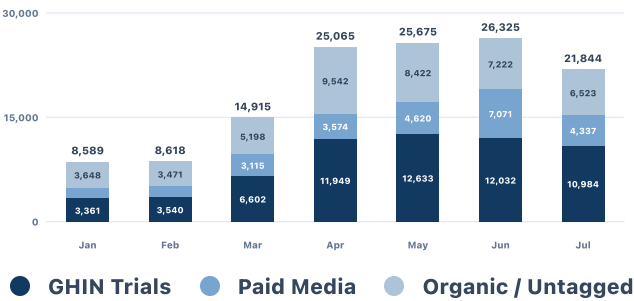
SOURCE MIX

YTD Acquisition Mix



MONTHLY SOURCE MIX

Monthly Trend by Source



GC Retention

Retention measures renewal performance and durability across the active membership base.

JULY ON-TIME RENEWAL RATE

83.4%

vs 66.0% last July

JULY 12M ROLLING RETENTION

79.0%

vs 73.5% last July

ACTIVE TODAY

525,382

August 2, 2026

INACTIVE TODAY

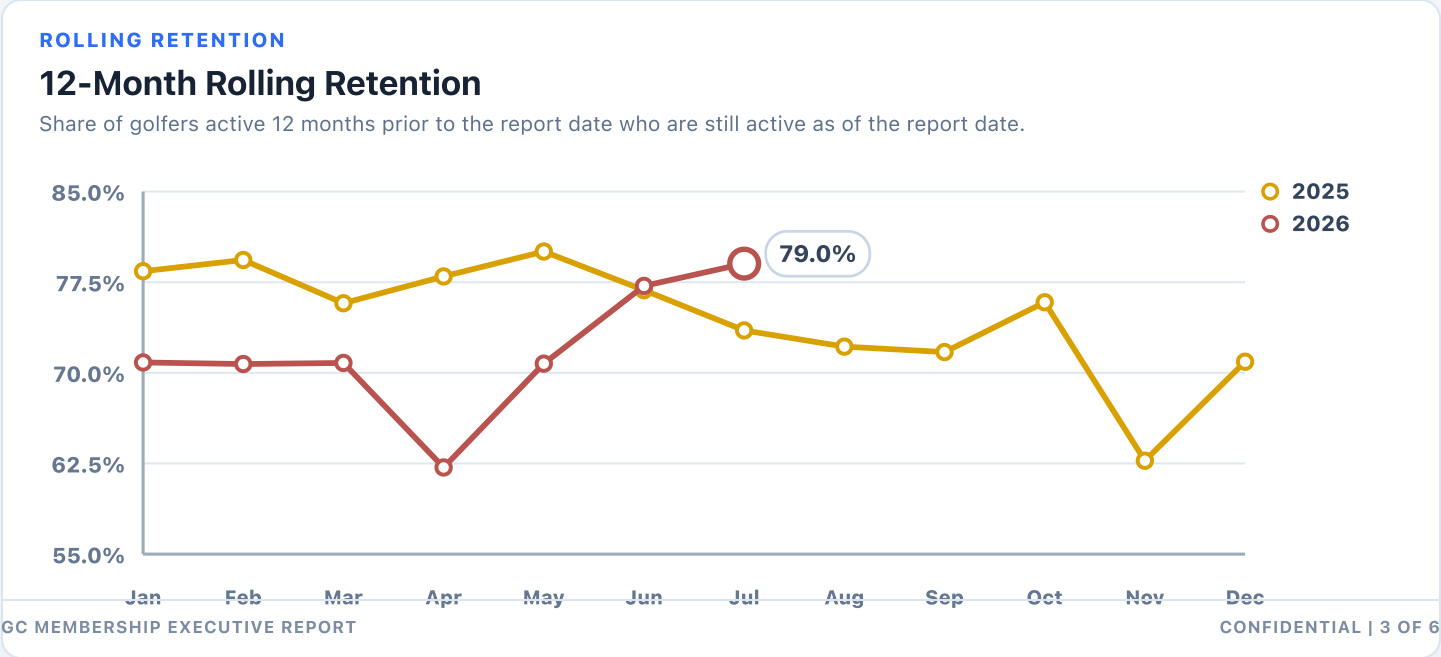
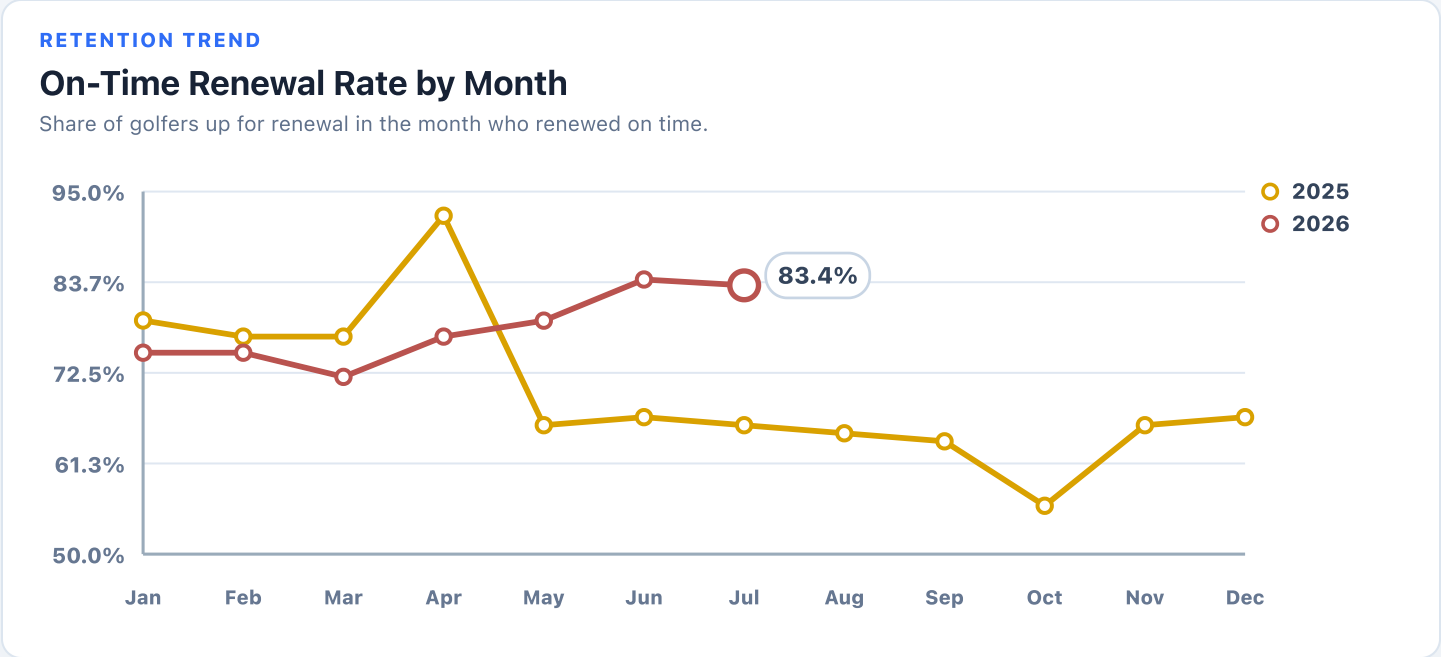
264,739

August 2, 2026

WHAT LEADERSHIP SHOULD KNOW

Key Takeaways

Retention is up significantly following the May auto-renewal changes, with July on-time renewal at 83.4% versus 66.0% last July. That retention lift is a major reason year-to-date membership growth remains strong despite softer acquisition.



GC Recovery

Recovery measures inactive golfers who returned to active membership during the reporting period.

REACTIVATIONS

4,934

-35.4% vs July 2025

July 2026

REACTIVATIONS YTD

39,664

+30.8% vs Jan-July 2025

Jan through July

YTD AS % OF ACTIVE

7.5%

+0.3% vs July 2025

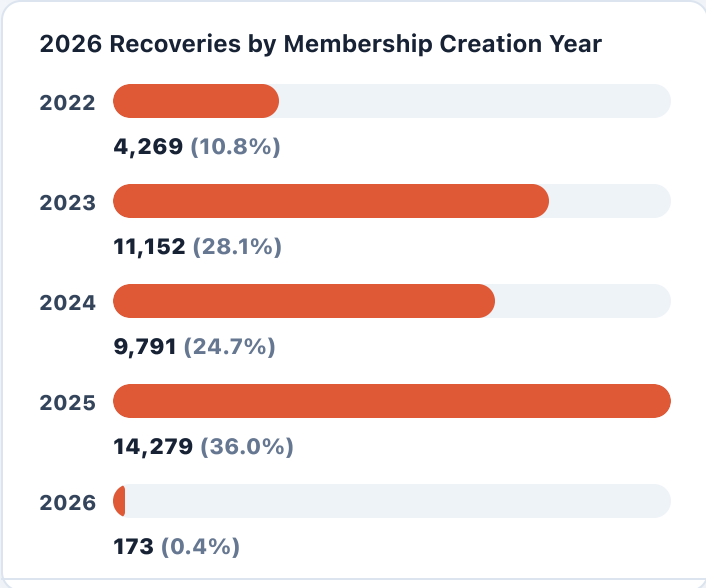
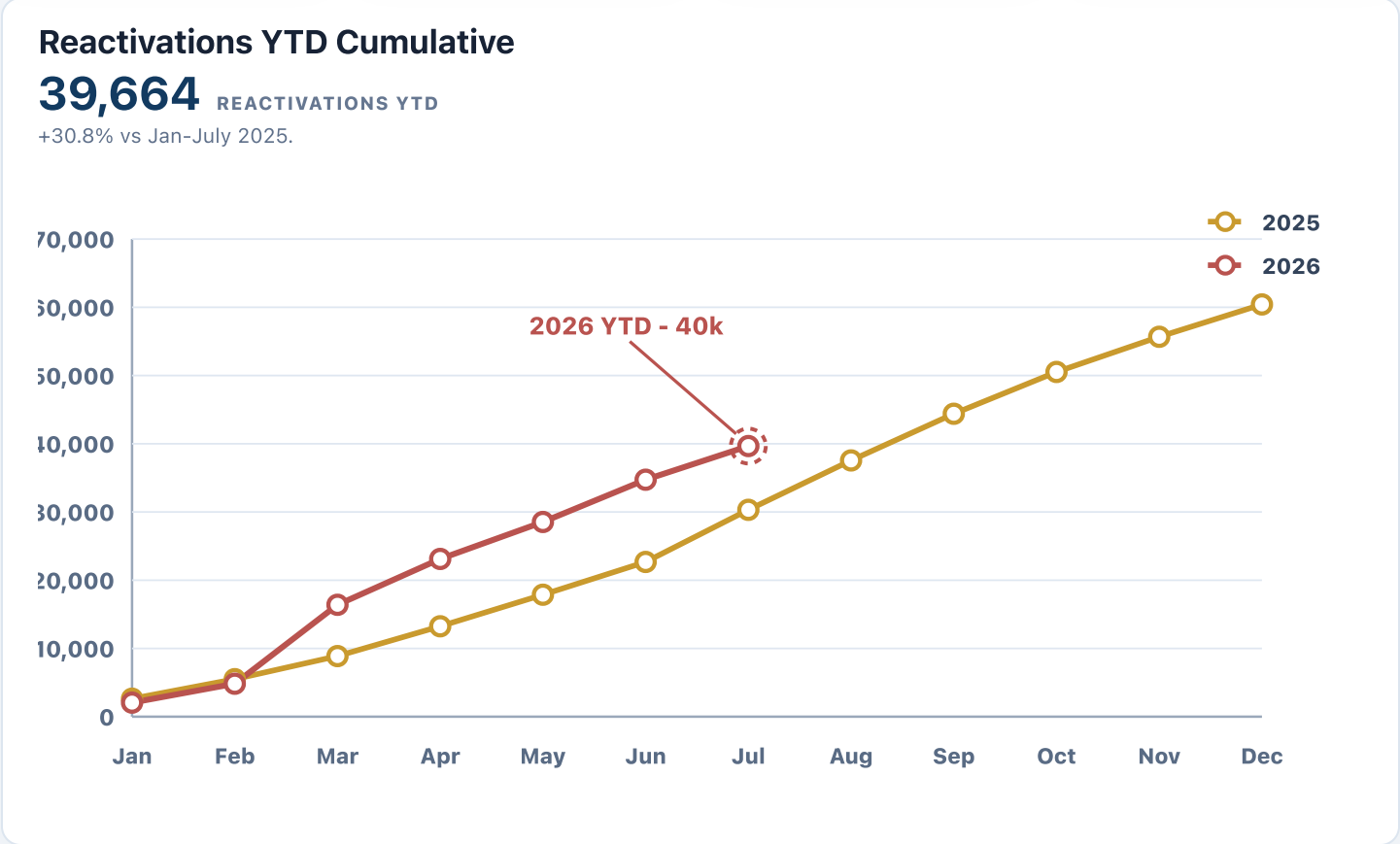
Current active base

MONTHLY AS % OF ACTIVE

0.9%

-0.9% vs July 2025

Selected month share



WHAT LEADERSHIP SHOULD KNOW

Key Takeaways

- Win-back automation is the opportunity**
Recovery can become an easier source of member wins if expired-member outreach is automated and scaled nationally.
- Retention team is testing the model**
The retention team has launched a win-back campaign to test whether this approach can work beyond a one-off effort.
- Expired members remain reachable**
Golfers from creation years as far back as 2022 are rejoining, suggesting there is no clear statute of limitations on asking lapsed members to return.

What the Numbers Are Telling Us

Membership is still strong...but.

Active membership is 525,382, up 25.0% versus July 2025 and up 81,139 year to date. The top-line membership position is still very strong, and the current projection has us on target to reach the year-end goal of roughly 554K active members.

However, the growth is being driven more by strong retention than by stronger acquisition, with new golfer creation softer than last year.

MEMBERSHIP YOY

+25.0%

RECOMMENDATION

The headline number is positive, but the next planning discussion should ask what is driving the increase, what is masking weakness, and where future growth will actually come from.

Acquisition is softer than last year.

New GC golfers are down 2.3% year to date versus Jan-July 2025, and July new golfers were down 14.1% versus July 2025. That is the clearest soft spot in the current report.

This does not mean acquisition is failing, and the cause is not yet clear. It could reflect a maturing growth market, a weaker-than-expected U.S. Open lift, or a problem with current marketing and conversion efforts. What is clear is that new golfer growth is not currently matching the strength of the overall membership number.

NEW GC GOLFERS
YTD

-2.3%

RECOMMENDATION

Make a deliberate effort now to identify the root causes behind slower acquisition and address them directly in 2027 planning. We should not make assumptions about the cause, but investigate it using the data available.

Retention is doing a lot of the work.

July on-time renewal is 83.4%, well above 66.0% last July, and July 12-month rolling retention is 79.0%, also above last year. The May auto-renewal changes appear to be the primary driver, helping protect the active base while new golfer creation is running behind last year.

JULY ON-TIME
RENEWAL

83.4%

RECOMMENDATION

This is a great development, but we should still look for incremental improvement in renewal communications where possible. We should also investigate the path to implementing auto-renewal across all AGAs for public members.

What the Numbers Are Telling Us

Recovery looks like a practical opportunity.

Recoveries are 39,664 year to date, up 30.8% versus Jan-July 2025. Recovered members are coming from creation years as far back as 2022, which suggests expired members remain reachable longer than we might assume.

If we invest in automating the win-back process and segment the lapsed member list and messaging, this could become a valuable way to help us grow GC membership long term.

RECOVERY YTD

+30.8%

RECOMMENDATION

Define what performance would justify automating win-back nationally, and investigate the time and cost required to build the plan.

The 2027 Growth Question

The last four to five years of GC membership development have clearly worked. GC membership has grown from zero to 525,382 active members, which is a tremendous achievement. GC has made getting a Handicap Index faster and easier, paid media campaigns have boosted visibility and demand, and the GHIN product has brought in tens of thousands of new members through product improvements and free trials.

Affiliate marketing is a very smart 2026 and 2027 bet. It should have a measurable impact on GC membership growth because it will make the product more widely available, easier to buy, and easier to integrate into an existing golf app experience.

But the current numbers raise a separate question: is access to the Handicap Index the main issue, or is new demand beginning to level off? If making the product more widely available is not enough on its own, should we consider additional ways to generate demand?

RECOMMENDATION

For 2027, answer the demand question directly: who buys a GC membership? What are the three primary reasons for that purchase? Can we leverage that answer to organize our resources around it and generate more demand?